KSB Ltd. | Buy | TP: Rs 940 | Upside: 24%

Nuclear opportunity anchoring growth outlook

MONARCH NETWORTH CAPITAL

Company Update

We retain BUY on KSB with TP revised to Rs 940 (vs Rs 920 earlier) on valuation rollover to CY27. We appreciate KSB's margin resilience, improving product mix, and a visible growth runway led by NPCIL-linked nuclear orders. Backed by strong fundamentals, including a net-cash balance sheet, and favorable tailwinds in the form of increased private sector participation in India's nuclear build-out drives our positive stance on KSB's medium-term growth outlook. However, possible gas supply shortage emanating from the ongoing unrest in the Middle East may start to impact operations in 2-4 months if the situation does not improve. We have baked in revenue/EBITDA/PAT CAGR of ~13%/13%/14% over CY25–CY28E with minor changes to our estimates. We maintain a cautiously optimistic stance given fine balancing between structural growth drivers and emerging macro headwinds.

- **Margins Outperform Amid Topline Miss:** KSB delivered a steady Q4, with revenue at Rs 7,840mn (+7.9% YoY, +20.7% QoQ), ~6% below estimates. EBITDA beat expectations at Rs1,296mn (+31.7% YoY, +52.8% QoQ), with margins expanding to 16.5% (+298 bps YoY, +348 bps QoQ), led by robust Pumps segment profitability (+9% YoY) while Valves remained subdued (+2% YoY). PAT stood at Rs 810 mn (+10.8% YoY), impacted by a one-off labour code charge of Rs255mn. For CY25, revenue reached Rs 26,957 mn (+6.4% YoY) and EBITDA Rs 3,735 mn (+10.7% YoY; margin 13.9%, +53 bps YoY). Margin expansion was aided by favourable mix, including partial execution of nuclear orders (~Rs 400 mn), a DND pump order, and strong aftermarket traction. The management has guided to a sustainable EBITDA margin range of 13–14% going forward.
- **KSB marginally ahead, albeit both underwhelming:** KSB's Q4CY25 performance was relatively better than Kirloskar Brothers; this was visible in the former's sales growth at 7.9% YoY; and EBITDA margin expanding to 16.5% (+300 bps YoY). On the flip side, Kirloskar Brothers reported a 2.4% YoY sales decline, 14.5% EBITDA decline, and margin contraction to 12.7% (-180 bps YoY), impacted by JJM funding delays and adverse sales mix. Both operate in overlapping pumps and valves segments; however, KSB's better sales mix aided relative resilience this quarter. Despite seasonally strong Q4, the quarter remained broadly soft.
- **NPCIL orders approval-led growth trigger:** KSB's order book stands at ~Rs 25.8 bn (-2% QoQ), with ~Rs 12.8 bn tied to NPCIL nuclear pump orders. Testing of two reactor coolant pumps (RCP) supplied by KSB is scheduled from 22nd March at the NPCIL's testbed in Tarapur, with the process likely spanning ~2 months; Upon clearance, the nuclear segment could scale to a Rs 2–3 bn annual opportunity. Supported by India's nuclear build-out and diversified exposure to solar pumps, water & wastewater, mining and firefighting, we retain a constructive medium-term view, baking in ~13% revenue CAGR over CY25–CY28e.
- **Valuation and rating:** While KSB's performance for CY25 was broadly in line, we remain cautiously optimistic given topline visibility on the back of order book build up. Our target multiple remains unchanged at 45x Dec'27e EPS and arrives at a TP of Rs 940. **Key risks:** Spillover effects from Middle East crisis, unfavorable domestic capex cycle, and further delay in NPCIL approvals.

Target price	940
CMP	760
Upside	24%

Price Performance (%)	1M	6M	1Yr
KSB	5%	-12%	6%
Nifty	-8%	-7%	5%

Key Data	
Bloomberg Code	KSB:IN
Curr Shares O/S (mn)	174
Diluted Shares O/S (mn)	174
Mkt Cap (RSbn/USDbn)	132/1.4
52 Wk H / L (Rs)	912/648
3M Avg Volume (thds)	451.3

Source: Bloomberg, NSE, Company

Shareholding pattern (%)

	Mar-25	Jun-25	Sep-25	Dec-25
KSB SE	40.54	40.54	40.54	40.54
Swarup Family	29.24	29.24	29.24	29.24
DIIs	11.07	11.39	11.57	11.95
FPIs	4.86	4.68	4.58	4.52
Others	14.29	14.13	14.05	13.75

Source: BSE

Estimate changes

Y/E December, Rs mn	CY26E	CY27E
Revenue, new	32,571	35,829
Revenue, old	33,986	37,441
Change	-4.2%	-4.3%
EBITDA, new	4,539	4,993
EBITDA, old	4,455	4,983
Change	1.9%	0.2%
PAT, new	3,261	3,639
PAT, old	3,333	3,618
Change	-2.2%	0.6%

Source: Company, MNCL Research

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Y/E (Rs in mn)	Revenue	YoY (%)	EBITDA	EBTDA Margins (%)	PAT	YoY (%)	EPS	RoAE	RoCE	P/E (x)	EV/EBITDA (x)
CY24	25,331	13%	3,375	13.3%	2,475	19%	14.2	17.8%	17.8%	14.2x	38.6x
CY25	26,957	6%	3,735	13.9%	2,705	9%	15.5	17.1%	17.1%	15.5x	34.4x
CY26E	32,571	21%	4,539	13.9%	3,261	21%	18.7	19.1%	19.1%	18.7x	28.2x
CY27E	35,829	10%	4,993	13.9%	3,639	12%	20.9	17.6%	17.6%	20.9x	25.4x
CY28E	39,475	10%	5,501	13.9%	4,038	11%	23.2	17.2%	17.2%	23.2x	22.8x

Source: Company, MNCL Research estimates

KTAs from the Management conference call

Business performance & order book

- Order intake, ex-nuclear, stood at Rs 29,920 mn in CY25, delivering 19% CAGR over CY22-25, driven by energy, exports, water, buildings, and services.
- Total order book stands at Rs 25,848 mn, including Rs 12,816 mn from nuclear, implying a book-to-bill of 0.96x.
- Order mix (ex-nuclear) remains diversified, with ~48% standard products, 19% engineered, 18% valves, and 15% supremeserv.
- Export order inflows have grown at ~22% CAGR over CY21-25, with export order mix improving to ~17% of order inflows in CY25 from 12% in CY24.
- Solar segment delivered ~Rs 2,450 mn revenue in CY25 and is expected to grow ~20%, with at least ~Rs 3,000 mn revenue expected in CY26.
- Strong pipeline across domestic markets, including Thermal Power Projects (NTPC, Adani, JSW), nuclear, and infrastructure projects.

Segment outlook & growth drivers

- Nuclear remains a key structural opportunity with potential of Rs 2,000–3,000 mn sales annually and strong positioning across reactor coolant and auxiliary pumps. NPCIL will start testing KSB's pumps from 22nd March and the process may take a couple of months.
- Water and wastewater segment is scaling up with new product launches, including vertical turbine pumps, and municipal project wins across major cities.
- Solar pumps are expected to continue growing, driven by the PM-KUSUM scheme. KSB should benefit from in-house controller manufacturing and improved distribution reach.
- Thermal power projects provide steady opportunity with high-value boiler feed pumps, while opportunity in boiler circulation pumps with BHEL is an emerging area. KSB does not supply cooling water pumps.
- Mining pumps segment is developing, with export opportunities following approvals from companies like GWI in the USA, along with domestic leadership in vertical mining pumps and development of Gen 2.0 pumps.
- New segments such as firefighting, water, wastewater, and hydrogen are contributing incremental growth from a low base. Data centres are also an emerging opportunity where KSB has the capability to supply the entire pump portfolio required, though it is currently negligible and opportunity size is not known.
- Exports remain a key growth lever, with increasing penetration in Africa, the Middle East, and developed markets, supported by the parent company network.

Margin profile & business mix

- Margin expansion in CY25 was driven by favourable mix, including limited nuclear order execution and strong aftermarket contribution.
- EBITDA margins are expected to sustain at ~13–14% over the near to medium-term, supported by favourable mix and operating leverage.
- Standard pumps (~50% of revenue) provide stable margins and strong cash flows due to fast turnover and a distribution-led model.
- SupremeServ (aftermarket) is the most profitable segment, contributing ~15% of revenue in CY25.
- Nuclear and export businesses are margin accretive due to higher realizations and better cash cycle.
- Engineered/project business faces margin pressure due to competitive intensity in refinery, petrochemical, and thermal segments.
- Solar segment supports growth but has a weaker cash conversion profile.
- Export margins are structurally higher, aided by better pricing and benefits from rupee depreciation.

Other (Geopolitical risks, cash flow & execution)

- Around 50% of business has price variation clauses, while the rest (project/engineered business) carries risk from commodity price volatility.
- Key approvals such as NPCIL testing and EIL certification remain critical for scaling nuclear and reciprocating pump opportunities.
- The current middle east war has led to gas availability issues for KSB's foundry operations and could affect its casting supplies. KSB is actively trying to replace these gas-based furnaces with electric furnaces for the time being but if the issue persists for another 2-3 months than that may lead to some disruption in operations.
- Exports to the Middle East is also expected to face disruptions due to the prevailing situation, although direct exports is minimal (~3% of revenue).
- Reciprocating pumps and mechanical seals are under development, and on receiving approvals from EIL, the company will be able to bid for PSU orders.
- Mechanical seal sales in CY25 was Rs 150 mn and increasing installed base should drive growth moving forward.

Exhibit 1: Q4CY25 Results summary

Y/E Mar	Q4CY25	Q4CY24	Q3CY25	YoY	QoQ	CY25	CY24	YoY
Net revenue (Rs mn)	7,840	7,264	6,496	*7.9%*	*20.7%*	26,957	25,331	*6.4%*
EBITDA (Rs mn)	1,296	984	848	*31.7%*	*52.8%*	3,735	3,375	*10.7%*
PAT (Rs mn)	810	731	675	*10.8%*	*20.0%*	2,705	2,475	*9.3%*
Gross margin	45.9%	43.4%	47.5%	*255 bps*	*-159bps*	46.0%	43.9%	*212 bps*
EBITDA margin	16.5%	13.5%	13.1%	*298 bps*	*348 bps*	13.9%	13.3%	*53 bps*
PAT margin	10.3%	10.1%	10.4%	*20bps*	*-10 bps*	10.0%	9.8%	*20 bps*
ROE (TTM)						17.1%	17.8%	*-70 bps*
Net Revenue by segment								
Pumps	6569	6,022	5331	*9.1%*	*23.2%*	22,150	21,081	*5%*
Valves	1,271	1,242	1,165	*2.3%*	*9.1%*	4,807	4,250	*13%*
Net Revenue	**7,840**	**7,264**	**6,496**	*7.9%*	*20.7%*	**26,957**	**25,331**	*7.9%*
EBIT Margin, reported								
Pumps	16.5%	10.9%	13.3%	*562 bps*	*325 bps*	12.9%	11.0%	*188 bps*
Valves	13.9%	18.0%	12.7%	*-403 bps*	*122 bps*	14.5%.	15.2%	*-73 bps*
Cash cycle						**180**	**155**	
Receivable days						103	83	
Inventory days						179	165	
Payable days						102	92	
*Adjusted cash conversion days						109	105	

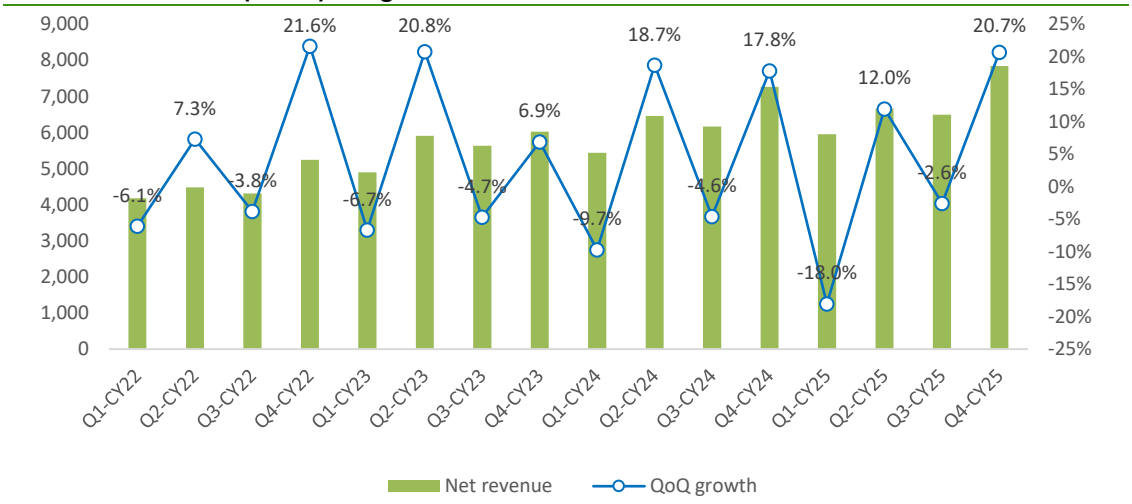
Source: Company, MNCL Research, *Adjusted for customer advances and export incentives

Exhibit 2: KSB vs KBL Q4CY25 Results Comparison

Rs mn	Kirloskar Brothers Ltd	KSB Ltd
Period	**Q3FY26**	**Q4CY25**
Revenue	11,162	7,840
% YoY	*-2.4%*	*7.9%*
Gross Profit	5,469	3,602
% YoY	*-6.3%*	*14.3%*
EBITDA	1,418	1,296
% YoY	*-14.5%*	*31.7%*
EBITDA Margin	12.7%	16.5%
PAT	1,243	810
% YoY	*6.1%*	*10.8%*
PAT Margin	11.1%	10.3%

Source: Company, MNCL Research

Exhibit 3: KSB's sales (Rs mn) and growth trend



Source: Company, MNCL Research

Financials – IS, BS, CFS

Exhibit 4: Consolidated Quarterly Income statement

In Rs mn,; CY-end Dec	Q1-CY24	Q2-CY24	Q3-CY24	Q4-CY24	Q1-CY25	Q2-CY25	Q3-CY25	Q4-CY25
Net revenue	**5,442**	**6,460**	**6,165**	**7,264**	**5,954**	**6,667**	**6,496**	**7,840**
COGS	**3,142**	**3,641**	**3,326**	**4,112**	**3,233**	**3,684**	**3,408**	**4,238**
Gross Profit	**2,300**	**2,819**	**2,839**	**3,152**	**2,721**	**2,983**	**3,088**	**3,602**
Employee benefits expense	757	755	796	828	928	864	941	910
Other expenses	934	1,158	1,167	1,340	1,116	1,205	1,299	1,396
Total Expenses	**4,833**	**5,554**	**5,289**	**6,280**	**5,277**	**5,753**	**5,648**	**6,544**
EBITDA	**609**	**906**	**876**	**984**	**677**	**914**	**848**	**1,296**
Depreciation and amortisation	129	133	137	144	139	140	148	156
Earnings before interest and taxes	**480**	**773**	**739**	**840**	**538**	**774**	**700**	**1,140**
Interest and other non-operating income	105	95	66	102	125	118	185	164
Interest expense on debt and pension obligation	9	8	6	4	8	7	7	8
Share of net profit of associate	21	39	32	42	35	37	33	41
Exceptional items	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	255
Profit before tax	**597**	**899**	**831**	**980**	**690**	**922**	**911**	**1,082**
Total tax expense	151	218	214	249	174	218	236	272
Profit after taxes	**446**	**681**	**617**	**731**	**516**	**704**	**675**	**810**
Earnings per share	2.6	3.9	3.5	4.2	3.0	4.0	3.9	4.7
Shares outstanding (mn)	174	174	174	174	174	174	174	174

Source: Company, MNCL Research

Exhibit 5: Consolidated Income Statement

In INR mn; CY-end Dec	CY21	CY22	CY23	CY24	CY25	CY26E	CY27E	CY28E
Net revenue	**14,973**	**18,220**	**22,472**	**25,331**	**26,957**	**32,571**	**35,829**	**39,475**
YoY growth	23.9%	21.7%	23.3%	12.7%	6.4%	20.8%	10.0%	10.2%
Cost of goods sold	7,924	9,880	12,775	14,221	14,563	17,589	19,348	21,317
Gross profit	**7,049**	**8,340**	**9,697**	**11,109**	**12,394**	**14,983**	**16,481**	**18,159**
Gross margin	47.1%	45.8%	43.2%	43.9%	46.0%	46.0%	46.0%	46.0%
SG&A expenses	4,954	5,873	6,762	7,734	8,659	10,444	11,488	12,657
EBITDA	**2,095**	**2,466**	**2,936**	**3,375**	**3,735**	**4,539**	**4,993**	**5,501**
EBITDA margin	**14.0%**	**13.5%**	**13.1%**	**13.3%**	**13.9%**	**13.9%**	**13.9%**	**13.9%**
Depreciation and amortization	435	453	497	543	583	648	717	793
Earnings before interest and taxes	1,659	2,014	2,439	2,832	3,152	3,891	4,276	4,708
Non-operating income / expenses	287	361	270	340	307	287	380	451
Share of net profit of associate	64	78	94	134	146	168	193	222
Profit before taxes	**2,010**	**2,453**	**2,803**	**3,307**	**3,605**	**4,346**	**4,849**	**5,381**
Income taxes	516	625	716	832	900	1,085	1,211	1,343
Effective tax rate	26%	25%	26%	25%	25%	25%	25%	25%
Profit after taxes	**1,494**	**1,827**	**2,087**	**2,475**	**2,705**	**3,261**	**3,639**	**4,038**
PAT margin	**10.0%**	**10.0%**	**9.3%**	**9.8%**	**10.0%**	**10.0%**	**10.2%**	**10.2%**

Source: Company, MNCL Research Estimates

Exhibit 6: Consolidated Balance Sheet

In INR mn; CY-end Dec	CY21	CY22	CY23	CY24	CY25	CY26E	CY27E	CY28E
Cash and cash equivalents	566	320	1,195	959	1,668	3,188	4,337	5,886
Bank balance, mostly deposits	**2,980**	**2,291**	**1,550**	**2,276**	**1,166**	**1,166**	**1,166**	**1,166**
Trade receivable	2,925	4,135	4,960	6,522	8,718	9,129	10,503	11,127
Inventories	4,231	5,611	6,426	6,428	7,861	8,523	9,500	10,357
Other ST assets	**646**	**481**	**572**	**871**	**1,362**	**1,302**	**1,362**	**1,501**
Current assets, total	**11,348**	**12,836**	**14,704**	**17,056**	**20,775**	**23,308**	**26,868**	**30,037**
Property, plant and equipment, net	**3,106**	**3,501**	**4,204**	**4,403**	**4,646**	**5,138**	**5,675**	**6,263**
Capital work-in-progress	392	251	310	528	889	889	889	889
Investment in associates	697	742	795	878	965	1,056	1,160	1,280
Other non-current assets	551	918	644	615	651	651	651	651
Total assets	**16,094**	**18,248**	**20,657**	**23,480**	**27,926**	**31,041**	**35,243**	**39,121**
Short-term borrowings	10	9	11	13	15	15	15	15
Trade payables	2,792	3,143	3,433	3,753	4,413	5,225	5,377	6,303
Customer advances and Other ST Liabilities	2,647	3,199	3,721	4,246	5,817	5,626	6,960	6,903
Current liabilities, total	**5,448**	**6,351**	**7,165**	**8,012**	**10,245**	**10,865**	**12,351**	**13,221**
Lease liabilities	20	20	21	22	37	37	37	37
Other non-current liabilities, mainly provisions	517	446	452	593	856	856	856	856
Total liabilities	**5,985**	**6,817**	**7,638**	**8,627**	**11,138**	**11,758**	**13,244**	**14,114**
Shareholders' equity	10,108	11,431	13,019	14,854	16,788	19,283	21,999	25,006
Total liabilities and shareholder equity	**16,094**	**18,248**	**20,657**	**23,480**	**27,926**	**31,041**	**35,243**	**39,121**

Source: Company, MNCL Research Estimates

Exhibit 7: Cash Flow Statement

In INR mn; FY-end Dec	CY21	CY22	CY23	CY24	CY25	CY26E	CY27E	CY28E
Profit after taxes	1,494	1,827	2,087	2,475	2,705	3,261	3,639	4,038
Depreciation and amortization	435	453	497	543	583	648	717	793
Other non-cash items	331	329	456	557	393	760	767	800
Changes in working capital	-873	-1,622	-930	-1,036	-1,692	-393	-925	-751
Taxes paid	-763	-604	-696	-667	-1,063	-1,085	-1,211	-1,343
Cash flow from operations	**625**	**382**	**1,414**	**1,871**	**926**	**3,192**	**2,988**	**3,537**
Capital expenditure	-382	-1,069	-933	-1,006	-936	-1,140	-1,254	-1,382
Interest received	192	204	190	209	253	174	268	339
Changes in investments	185	690	741	-725	1,105	0	0	0
Dividend from associate	27	32	39	47	67	77	89	102
Other investing flows	7	16	8	11	8	0	0	0
Cash flow from investing activities	**28**	**-127**	**45**	**-1,464**	**497**	**-889**	**-898**	**-941**
Changes in debt	-611	-12	-13	-15	-14	0	0	0
Interest paid	-48	-58	-50	-24	-11	-18	-18	-18
Dividend paid	-296	-435	-522	-609	-696	-766	-923	-1,030
Tax on dividend paid	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Cash flow from financing activities	**-954**	**-506**	**-585**	**-648**	**-721**	**-783**	**-941**	**-1,048**
Net change in cash	-301	-251	874	-241	702	1,520	1,150	1,548
Opening cash balance	871	566	320	1,195	959	1,668	3,188	4,337
Impact of FX changes	-4	4	1	5	7	0	0	0
Ending cash balance	**566**	**320**	**1,195**	**959**	**1,668**	**3,188**	**4,337**	**5,886**

Source: Company, MNCL Research Estimates

Exhibit 8: Key Ratios

Y/E December	CY21	CY22	CY23	CY24	CY25	CY26E	CY27E	CY28E
Growth Ratio (%)								
Power-driven Pumps	25.2%	19.7%	24.7%	11.9%	5.1%	22.1%	9.0%	9.1%
Industrial Valves	17.7%	26.5%	16.8%	22.2%	13.1%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%
Revenue	23.9%	21.7%	23.3%	12.7%	6.4%	20.8%	10.0%	10.2%
EBITDA	24.8%	17.7%	19.0%	15.0%	10.7%	21.5%	10.0%	10.2%
Net income	59.3%	22.3%	14.2%	18.6%	9.3%	20.5%	11.6%	11.0%
Margin Ratios (%)								
Gross profit	47.1%	45.8%	43.2%	43.9%	46.0%	46.0%	46.0%	46.0%
EBIT	11.1%	11.1%	10.9%	11.2%	11.7%	11.9%	11.9%	11.9%
EBITDA	14.0%	13.5%	13.1%	13.3%	13.9%	13.9%	13.9%	13.9%
Net income	10.0%	10.0%	9.3%	9.8%	10.0%	10.0%	10.2%	10.2%
DuPont (%)								
PAT-to-sales	10.0%	10.0%	9.3%	9.8%	10.0%	10.0%	10.2%	10.2%
Sales-to-assets	0.9	1.0	1.1	1.1	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
Assets-to-equity	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.7	1.6	1.6	1.6
ROE	15.7%	17.0%	17.1%	17.8%	17.1%	19.1%	17.6%	17.2%
ROA	9.5%	10.6%	10.7%	11.2%	10.5%	12.0%	11.0%	10.9%
ROCE	13.7%	14.7%	15.6%	16.0%	15.8%	24.1%	21.9%	21.1%
ROIC	20.4%	19.4%	19.0%	19.3%	18.4%	21.9%	20.4%	20.4%
Turnover Ratios (days) *								
Receivable days	70	71	74	83	103	100	100	100
Inventory days	181	182	172	165	179	170	170	170
Payable days	125	110	94	92	102	100	100	100
Cash conversion days	126	143	152	155	180	170	170	170
Export incentives and advances to suppliers	8	6	5	7	11	11	10	10
Customer advances	61	58	57	58	81	80	80	80
Adjusted cash conversion days	73	91	100	105	109	101	100	100
Solvency Ratios								
Net debt-to-equity	-35%	-23%	-21%	-22%	-17%	-22%	-25%	-28%
Debt-to-equity	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
CFO-to-EBITDA	30%	16%	48%	55%	25%	70%	60%	64%
Capex-to-net revenue	2.6%	5.9%	4.2%	4.0%	3.5%	3.5%	3.5%	3.5%
Accrual ratio	5%	9%	3%	9%	5%			
Per share Ratios (INR)								
EPS	8.6	10.5	12.0	14.2	15.5	18.7	20.9	23.2
DPS	2.5	3.0	3.5	4.0	4.4	5.3	5.9	6.6
BVPS	58.1	65.7	74.8	85.3	96.5	110.8	126.4	143.7
CEPS	3.6	2.2	8.1	10.8	5.3	18.3	17.2	20.3
Valuation (x)								
P/E	28.3	36.9	57.8	54.0	48.5	40.6	36.4	32.8
P/B	4.2	5.9	9.3	9.0	7.8	6.9	6.0	5.3
P/S	2.8	3.7	5.4	5.3	4.9	4.1	3.7	3.4
EV/EBITDA	18.5	26.3	40.2	38.6	34.4	28.2	25.4	22.8

Source: Company, MNCL Research Estimates

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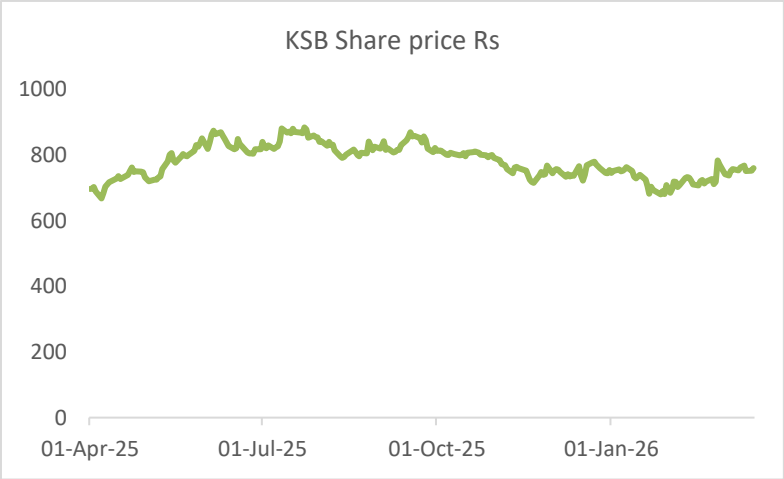

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